



Edit two files simultaneously in VIM

In VIM, we can open more than one file at a time. To do so, follow the steps given below:

1. Open a file with VIM
2. Get into command mode by typing : [i.e. colon]
3. Enter the command split 2ndfile
4. This will split the VIM window horizontally with the second file as the new buffer
5. Press Ctrl+w twice to move between the files
6. You can use all VIM commands in both files. You can even go on to open some more files.

If you want to learn more about VIM commands, enter Ctrl+d in the command mode (":") and you will get all possible VIM commands.

—Sathiyamoorthy N, n.sathiyamoorthy@gmail.com



Sending mails using the command line

First check, whether Sendmail is running:

```
# /etc/init.d/sendmail status
```

If the status shows that it's not, then start it:

```
# /etc/init.d/sendmail start
```

Then, send mails using either the mail or mutt command:

```
# echo "body of the mail" | mail -s "subject of the mail" toAddress
```

Give the recipient's mail ID in place of toAddress.

As for the body of the mail, you can also redirect it from a file, as follows:

```
# mail -s "subject of the mail" toaddress < body_mail.txt
```

If you want to send a file as an attachment, you can use mutt instead:

```
# echo "body of the mail" | mutt -s "subject of the mail" \
-a fileToAttach.txt toAddress
```

Give the recipient's e-mail ID in place of toAddress.

—Shiv Premani, shivpremani@gmail.com



Change your Bash prompt

You can change your Bash prompt by just setting the environment variable \$PS1:

```
[root@localhost usr]# echo $PS1
```

```
[\u@\h \W]#$
```

...where, \u is the user name, \h the hostname and \W is the current working directory.

Here's how you can set a new one with the export command.

```
[root@localhost usr]# export PS1="Hello #"
```

```
[hello] #
```

```
[hello]# export PS1="\u \t #"
```

```
root 10:14:00 #
```

...where, \t gives the current time in the 24-hour format.

You can execute commands to populate PS1 like PS1=" \$(uname -r) #" or even shell scripts can be called. All these special characters can be found in the Bash man page under the Prompting section.

—Saumitra Bhanage, bhanage.saumitra@gmail.com



Access Windows shares from the terminal

The following command will help you to access the Windows shares from Linux systems:

```
# mkdir /mnt/win
```

```
# mount -t cifs //server-ip-or-name/share /mnt/win -o username=user,password=pass,domain=DOMAIN
```

And to unmount the share, use the command given below:

```
# umount /mnt/win
```

—Sivakumar E, sivakumar.e@gmail.com

END

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